

2.1 Unit description

Explorative study and creative critical response

In this unit students will explore drama texts by reading or watching performance (live or filmed) and by reading, viewing or listening to examples of others' responses. Texts may be studied and tasks chosen for the group or the individual, as appropriate to the centre.

The requirement that **three** texts should be 'studied' in this unit should be interpreted to mean that in preparation for writing coursework students will study a play in detail, draw upon their knowledge of a further play(s) and/or explore relevant critical reception. This approach will enhance their ability to consider the contexts in which the texts were written and are received.

Centres and students are **free to choose their texts** to comply with the need to include a play by Shakespeare and a further play written between 1300 and 1800. The further play may be another play by Shakespeare or a play from a different playwright in the period specified. Students will produce a coursework folder that demonstrates that the four assessment objectives have been fully met.

To support informed student choice of texts, further guidance is provided in the tutor support materials.